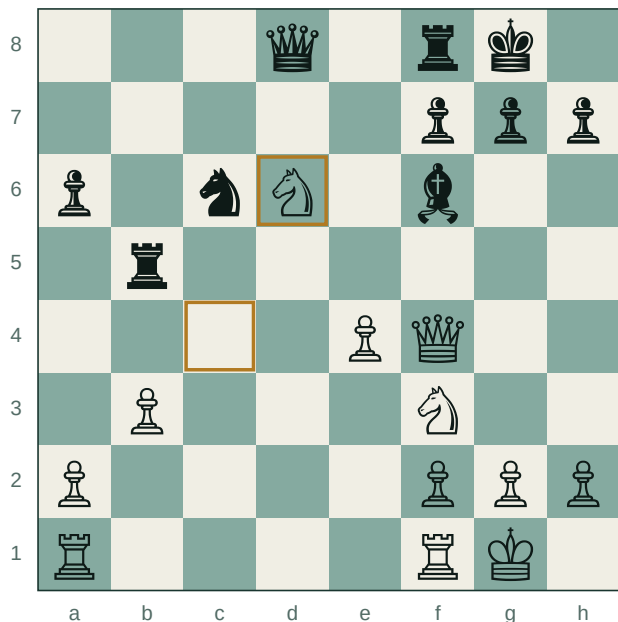


Interference tactics: Black, move 21

Interference tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 21.Nxd6. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

21...Be5 22. Nxe5 Qxd6 23. Rfd1 Qxe5

21...Be5 The bishop moves from f6 to e5. From e5 it attacks queen on f4, rook on a1 and knight on d6. Recorded reply: **22.Nxe5**.

22...Qxd6 The queen captures the knight on d6. Recorded reply: **23.Rfd1**.

23...Qxe5 The queen captures the knight on e5. From e5 it attacks queen on f4 and rook on a1.

At the end, nominal material is White 25 / Black 26 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +3: the balance goes from -2 to +1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Capturing the interposing piece may restore defense. Calculate which captures are legal and whether they permit another tactic.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Interference interrupts a defensive line between enemy pieces. Occupying one square can make a previously protected target vulnerable or prevent an important recapture.

HOW TO LOOK

Trace the defender's line to its target and inspect forcing moves onto the intervening squares.

The defending king is on g1. Geometrically undefended: queen on f4. Check for tactical protection.